straightforward, but is something that you need to understand if you plan to do sophisticated data visualization.

Let's say you have a dataset that consists of individuals from an insurance database, and you need to know how old someone is, whether they're employed, their name, and their children, if any. A JSON object that represents each individual in such a database would be expressed as follows:

```
{name: "Charlie", age: 55, employed: true, childrenNames: ["Ruth", "Charlie
Jr."]}
```

Each object is surround by braces,{}, and has attributes that have a string, number, array, boolean, or object as their value. You can assign an object to a variable and access its attributes by referring to them, like so:

```
var person = {name: "Charlie", age: 55, employed: true, childrenNames:
["Ruth", "Charlie Jr."]};

person.name // Charlie
person["name"] // Charlie
person.name = "Charles" // Sets name to Charles
person["name"] = "Charles" // Sets name to Charles
person.age < 65 // true
person.childrenNames // ["Ruth", "Charlie Jr."]
person.childrenNames[0] // "Ruth"
```

Objects can be stored in arrays and associated with elements using `d3.select()` syntax. But objects can also be iterated through like arrays using a `for` loop:

```
for (x in person) {console.log(x); console.log(person[x]);}
```

The `x` in the loop represents each attribute in the `person` object. Each `x` will be one of the attributes such as `name`, `age`, and so on This allows you to iterate through the attributes using `person[x]` to show the value of that attribute of the object.

If your data is stored as JSON, then you can import it using `d3.json()`, which you'll see many times in later chapters. But remember that whenever you use `d3.csv()`, D3 imports the data as an array of JSON objects. We'll look at objects more extensively as we use them later.

1.5 Infoviz standards expressed in D3

Information visualization has never been so popular as it is today. The wealth of maps, charts, and complex representations of systems and datasets isn't just present in the workplace, but also in our entertainment and everyday lives. With this popularity comes a growing library of classes and subclasses of representation of data and information using visual means, as well as aesthetic rules to promote legibility and comprehension. Your audience, whether the general public, academics, or decision makers, has grown accustomed to what we once considered incredibly abstract and complicated representations of trends in data. This is why libraries like D3 are popular not only among data scientists, but also among journalists, artists, scholars, IT professionals, and even fan communities.